

on that system, this command will simply be ignored. For a more detailed tutorial on NFS, go to <https://www.vagrantup.com/docs/synced-folders/nfs.html>.

If you are creating a website using Laravel, you will want to map the domain to a folder on your Homestead environment. The inbuilt Nginx package helps you do that with ease. Fret not if you are not familiar with it. Nginx is an open source web server that also provides reverse proxy, load balancer and HTTP cache capabilities. A large part of the internet uses Nginx as a load balancer. To map the domain, use the command

```
- map: project.test
    to: /home/vagrant/code/Laravel/public
```

Next you need to redirect requests for your sites to your Homestead machine by adding the domain line to the hosts file on the local machine. On Mac and Linux, this file is located at /etc/hosts. On Windows, it is located at C:\Windows\System32\drivers\etc\hosts. In this file, add in the following line

```
Syntax- [IP Address from Homestead.yaml] [domain name]
Example- 192.168.10.10 project.test
```

We are finally ready to launch the virtual machine! Run the vagrant up command from your Homestead directory which will automatically configure all folders and Nginx sites.

Valet

Where Homestead offers a complete range of in-built products and is great for a full fledged programmer who requires all the functionalities. But if you are a Mac minimalist, you will fall in love with Valet. This method does not need Vagrant or changing the hosts file.

To set up Valet, follow these steps

- Install or update Homebrew to the latest version using `brew update`.
- Install PHP 7.2 using Homebrew via `brew install homebrew/php/php72`.
- Install Valet with Composer via `composer global require laravel/valet`. Make sure the `~/.composer/vendor/bin` directory is in your system's "PATH".
- Run the `valet install` command. This will configure and install Valet and DnsMasq, and register Valet's daemon to launch when your system starts.

You can install MySQL if you need to use a database or connect to another domain apart from the default.test domain that Valet offers. If you need to upgrade Valet, run the `composer global update` command. **d**